

Trophy

Alex Baker Ends the Waiting with 184

Twice a runner-up and once a Spoon holder, Alex Baker got better in every round and finished with the highest Trophy total TEG has recorded.

Alex Baker won the TEG 10 Trophy with 184 points, 11 clear of Gregg Williams. It is the highest Trophy total in the history of the competition, and comfortably his own best. There is no asterisk to attach and no argument to be had.

It was assembled in instalments. At Palmares, a course nobody in the field had seen before, he posted a personal best of 45 points on the Praia/Alvor loop, with a personal-best gross of +23. The following day, on Alvor/Lagos, he improved: 47 points, +22 gross, both personal bests again. He achieved that while taking a 10 at the par-five 13th. Five over par. No points. He appears to have regarded the hole as a private matter and moved on without comment.

The lead changed hands in that third round. David Mullin had held it for 30 holes, from the 12th of round one, and surrendered it at the sixth at Palmares, where Baker's par drew him level. Nothing more dramatic than a par. Baker led after round three on points and was never behind again.

The final round at Boavista removed the last of the doubt. Baker scored 51 points, the best round anyone has posted in TEG to date, off a gross +17 that was another personal best. The middle stretch did the work: 21 points across holes five to ten, four pars and two bogeys measured against the strokes he was receiving. His gross total of +90 was also a personal best, closing four days in which almost every round he played was the finest of his career.

AT A GLANCE
Trophy Winner Alex Baker (1st Trophy) Runner-up: Gregg Williams
Green Jacket David Mullin (8th Jacket) Runner-up: Jon Baker
Wooden Spoon John Patterson (1st Spoon) Next above: Stuart Neumann

FINAL · Trophy
AB 184 | GW 173 | DM 162 | JB 157 | SN 144 | JP 112
FINAL · Green Jacket
DM +51 | JB +63 | GW +76 | AB +90 | SN +125 | JP +132

Green Jacket

David Mullin Breaks Boavista, Then the Record Book

A 75 in R1 decided the TEG 10 Green Jacket before the field had settled; Jon Baker's personal-best gross total of +63 still lost by 12.

David Mullin won the TEG 10 Green Jacket at +51 gross, 12 clear of Jon Baker. It is the lowest gross total ever returned in a TEG, and his own best.

The matter was largely settled on the opening day. At Boavista, on his eleventh visit, Mullin went round in 75 gross, +4. It is the best gross round in TEG history and a new course record, beating the previous mark of 82 set across 50 prior visits. It was also 23 strokes better than his last outing

there. The same round yielded 49 Stableford points, the second-best round TEG has seen. Across the four days he recorded 6 birdies or better and 34 pars or better, both all-time records.

He was not immaculate. Having taken 42 points in round two at Palmares - Praia / Alvor, he managed 31 on the Alvor / Lagos loop the next day, a drop of 11, and closed that round with a quadruple-bogey 8 at the par-four 18th. Even the man rewriting the

record book is entitled to one lapse of concentration on a closing hole.

Jon Baker had the better of him once. His +10 gross at Palmares - Praia / Alvor in round two is the third-best gross round in TEG history. Baker also posted a personal-best gross total of +63 and a Boavista personal best of 86 in round four, improving on his previous 90. At no point did any of this trouble the leader.

Stuart Neumann | John Patterson

Two Rounds, Two Tens at the 18th

Stuart Neumann came to the Algarve with back-to-back Wooden Spoons behind him and dodged a third by 32 points, on merit that was almost entirely John Patterson's.

Stuart Neumann arrived in the Algarve with a decade of Boavista behind him, ten prior visits and a best gross of 82 from TEG 5, and discovered that the closing hole had entered his life as an administrative problem. In round one at Boavista he took 10 at the last. Six over par, at a stroke index 5 hole, for nothing. Twenty-four hours later, on the first ever TEG visit to the Praia/Alvor loop at Palmares, he did it again. Another 10 at the 18th, another six over, another blank. These are two different holes on two different courses, and no hole in his career has ever cost him more shots against par than either of them. They arrived in consecutive rounds, like a debt and its interest.

The Palmares round did not reserve its unpleasantness for the finish. He was five over at the 13th for a 10, five over again at the 14th for a 9, and three over at the 15th. Thirteen shots in three holes, not one of them producing a net par. What makes it remarkable is what came directly before: par, bogey, par, par from the 9th to the 12th, 14 Stableford points in four holes. For a quarter of an hour the round looked entirely governable.

It closed at 105. His best of the trip, a 98, waited politely until the return to Boavista in round four.

Wooden Spoon | John Patterson

Ten, Then Eleven, at Boavista's Eighth

John Patterson arrived as the TEG 9 Trophy holder and finished bottom of the field in every single round, 32 points behind Stuart Neumann.

John Patterson collected the TEG 10 Wooden Spoon, finishing on 112 points after four rounds in the Algarve.

The ruin came in isolated detonations rather than gradual decay. Boavista's par-five 8th claimed him twice: a 10 in the opening round, then an 11 in the final round, the highest score he has ever recorded on a par five. On both occasions he left with nothing written down. In between, the 1st at Palmares — Praia / Alvor took a 10 off him in round two, and the 8th at Palmares — Alvor / Lagos another 10 in round three.

That third round holds the worst of it. From the 11th to the 15th he went triple bogey, quintuple bogey, triple bogey, quadruple bogey, quadruple bogey. Nineteen shots dropped in five holes. Five holes without a net par. One Stableford point extracted from the entire enterprise.

The return to Boavista brought no clemency. Beyond the 11 at the 8th, he took 8 at the 10th and 9 at the closing hole, finishing on 21 points and 40 over gross. Both are the worst figures of his career, as a round and in gross terms.

His best gross of the four days was the 102 in round one at Boavista, on what was his first visit to a course the group has now played twelve times. He will have the other eleven to think about.

Gregg Williams | Alex Baker

Three Personal Bests, Still Eleven Short

Gregg Williams, a three-time Trophy winner, produced the best scoring of his TEG career and ran into an Alex Baker who was simply better.

Gregg Williams came to the Algarve and played the best scoring golf of his TEG career. His gross total of +76 is the lowest he has ever recorded at a TEG. This is not a consolation prize; it is genuinely his high-water mark.

The peak arrived in the second round, on the Praia/Alvor nines at Palmares, a course entirely new to everyone. Williams signed for 48 points, a personal best, and a gross of +14 that was also the finest round of his career by that measure. The scoring came in a five-hole burst from the 8th: pars at the 8th, 9th and 11th, a birdie at the 10th, which carries stroke index 4, and a bogey at the 12th. Eighteen points in five holes.

It had not begun in that spirit. On the opening day at Boavista he took nine at the 18th, a par four, a quintuple bogey worth precisely nothing.

Boavista offered a tidier farewell. Williams had played the course ten times before this TEG, with a previous best gross of 97. In the final round he went round in 93, a course best and ten strokes better than his last visit.

None of it, in the end, was enough to beat Alex Baker.

Records & Personal Bests

Notable achievements: TEG 10

TEG Records

- Jon Baker's +10 (gross) is the 3rd-best Gross round in TEG history to date (R2)
- David Mullin's +4 (gross) is the best Gross round in TEG history to date (R1)
- David Mullin's 49 pts is the 2nd-best round in TEG history to date (R1)
- Alex Baker's 51 pts is the best round in TEG history to date (R4)
- Alex Baker's 184 pts is the best Trophy total in TEG history
- David Mullin — -1 Gross on the Back nine (R1) is the best Back nine Gross in TEG history

Personal Bests

- Alex Baker posts a personal-best Gross round: +17 (R4)
- Gregg Williams posts a personal-best round: 48 pts (R2)
- Gregg Williams posts a personal-best Gross round: +14 (R2)
- Alex Baker posts a personal-best round: 47 pts (R3)
- Alex Baker posts a personal-best Gross round: +22 (R3)
- Alex Baker posts a personal-best round: 45 pts (R2)
- Alex Baker posts a personal-best Gross round: +23 (R2)
- Alex Baker's +90 is a personal Gross best
- David Mullin's +51 is a personal Gross best
- Alex Baker's 184 pts is a personal Trophy best
- Gregg Williams's 173 pts is a personal Trophy best
- David Mullin — -1 Gross on the Back nine (R1) is a personal-best Back nine Gross
- David Mullin — 28 Stableford on the Back nine (R1) is a personal-best Back nine Stableford
- Alex Baker — +6 Gross on the Front nine (R2) is a personal-best Front nine Gross
- Jon Baker — +1 Gross on the Front nine (R2) is a personal-best Front nine Gross
- Alex Baker — 28 Stableford on the Front nine (R2) is a personal-best Front nine Stableford
- Jon Baker — 27 Stableford on the Front nine (R2) is a personal-best Front nine Stableford

Personal Worsts

- John Patterson's worst round to date: 21 pts (R4)
- John Patterson's worst Gross round to date: +40 (R4)
- John Patterson's 12-hole "Over Par" streak is a personal worst (previous 7), at T10 R4 H7 to T10 R4 H18

Rare Feats

- John Patterson runs up an 11 (+6) at the 8th (R4) — his career-worst on a par-5
- Stuart Neumann runs up a 10 (+6) at the 18th (R2) — his career-worst on a par-4
- Stuart Neumann runs up a 10 (+6) at the 18th (R1) — his career-worst on a par-4